

GLOBAL WEEK IN REVIEW

Saturday, 1 August 2026 • Weekend companion to “Daily Need to Know”
Everything that mattered this week. Week ending Friday 31 July 2026 US close. All times GMT+8.

1. Weekly Market Snapshot

Levels are Friday 31 July 2026 US close. Weekly move vs Friday 24 July close. **Green = up** / **Red = down**.

Instrument	Fri Close	Week's Move	Note
S&P 500	7,489.72	+1.05%	Bounced into month-end on MSFT/AMZN; July finished ~flat (≈ -0.6% MTD).
Nasdaq Composite	25,373.85	+1.59%	Round-tripped a vicious mid-week AI/semis drawdown; TREND still bearish.
Dow Jones Ind.	52,485.03	+1.04%	Fourth straight winning month; value/defensive tilt helped.
US 10Y Yield	≈4.70%	higher	Highest since Jan 2025 on sticky inflation + supply (a level, not a %).
US 2Y Yield	≈4.31%	~flat	Anchored by the Fed's hold at 3.50–3.75%.
US 30Y Yield	≈5.25%	higher	Highest since 2007 — the week's loudest macro signal.
Dollar (DXY)	100.19	~flat	Capped by suspected Japanese yen intervention; TREND bullish.
Gold (spot)	≈\$4,086/oz	+~1%	Held ≈\$4,100; Hedgeye TREND bearish (extended).
Silver (spot)	≈\$58/oz	+~2%	Briefly >\$59 on Mideast headlines; supply-tight, TREND bearish.
Brent Crude	≈\$88/bbl	~flat	+~20% in July on Iran/Hormuz; eased late-week on US airstrike pause.
WTI Crude	≈\$85/bbl	~flat	Mid-\$80s; the macro pivot for inflation and the Fed's Sept call.
Bitcoin	≈\$63,870	~-2%	Slid into month-end though broad crypto had its best month in a year.

Note: minor cross-source divergence exists on some closes (e.g., aggregators quoting the S&P near 7,467 vs the 7,489.72 print used here); yield weekly moves are directional (verify basis-point deltas live).

2. TL;DR — What Defined the Week

A stagflationary week that stocks shrugged off. US Q2 GDP slowed to **1.5%** while June core PCE held at **3.3%**, and a Fed under new Chair **Kevin Warsh** held at **3.50–3.75%** (a divided **9–3**, three hawkish dissents) — driving the 30Y to its **highest since 2007** and the 10Y back above **4.7%**. Yet indices rallied into month-end as the AI-capex reckoning **split Big Tech**: **Microsoft** and **Amazon** soared on cloud, while **Alphabet** and **Meta** were punished for spending. Leadership rotated hard into energy, healthcare and defensives — and Hedgeye's model flags the tell: July's **#Quad4** is flipping to **#Quad3** for August as oil and commodities re-accelerate inflation.

3. The Big Picture — What the Week Meant

1) The AI-capex verdict split Big Tech

Microsoft rose ~8-9% (Azure +43%, RPO \$678B, 30M Copilot seats) and **Amazon** ~8-10% (AWS +37%, first \$200.6B quarter). By contrast **Alphabet** fell ~15% despite Cloud +82%, and **Meta** ~10% despite revenue +28% — both punished for AI capex. **Apple** slid on a memory/chip crunch and soft China/Services.

Read: Owning “AI infrastructure” is no longer a free pass — the market now demands ROIC visibility. Barbell toward hyperscalers **monetizing** cloud (MSFT, AMZN) and fade those still spending into the promise.

2) A factor unwind, not an index crash

Per Hedgeye, July was the **worst month for levered consensus hedge-fund positioning since 2023**: TMT memory -30.5%, GS high-beta momentum -30.9%, AI data centers -19.4%. Yet the same month paid GARP software +8.4%, US healthcare +5.3% and REITs +4.5%. Even on down-momentum days, **71% of SPY names were green**.

Read: This is a crowded-trade purge, not a market breakdown. Fade strength in momentum/growth; own dividends, healthcare, energy and equal-weight.

3) Rates repriced higher — stagflation, not disinflation

The **30Y** hit its **highest since 2007** and the **10Y** topped **4.7%**, its highest since January 2025 — the collision of sticky **3.3%** core PCE, slowing **1.5%** growth and a hawkish Warsh Fed.

Read: Duration is a source of risk, not safety. The long end is doing the Fed’s tightening; long bonds remain a poor hedge in a Quad3 tape.

4) Oil is the macro pivot

Brent gained ~20% in July on Iran / Strait-of-Hormuz escalation before a late-week **US airstrike pause** eased the spike and helped equities bounce.

Read: Energy is simultaneously the inflation driver and the leadership trade. Own the cash-flow (XLE, refiners); the commodity itself is the swing factor for the September Fed decision.

5) The Fed held — but the hawks are restless

The FOMC held **3.50-3.75%** on a **9-3** vote, with three officials (incl. Logan, Hammack) dissenting for **hikes**. Warsh shortened the statement and stressed conditions over guidance; markets now price the **first 2026 hike for September**.

Read: “Higher for longer” has mutated into “maybe higher.” Front-end carry is fine; the tail risk is a hawkish surprise, not a cut.

6) Regime shift: Quad4 → Quad3

Hedgeye’s US monthly Nowcast was **#Quad4** for July (growth & inflation both slowing) and flips to **#Quad3** for August (growth slowing, inflation **re-accelerating**) on the commodity breakout.

Read: Quad3 favors energy, gold/precious, commodities and value/quality; it punishes long-duration growth and long bonds. Position for the inflation re-acceleration.

4. Rates, Currencies & Commodities

Rates & credit

The curve steepened the ugly way: **10Y** ≈4.70% (highest since Jan 2025), **30Y** ≈5.25% (highest since 2007), while the **2Y** ≈4.31% stayed pinned by the Fed hold. Credit stayed orderly — high yield (**HYG**) neutral in a **78.97-79.76** range,

but investment grade (LQD) bearish (105.7–107.3) as duration bit. Drivers: sticky inflation, heavy issuance, and wavering faith in Warsh's resolve.

Currencies

The DXY closed ≈100.19, broadly flat on the week and capped by suspected **Japanese intervention** to strengthen the yen. Hedgeye's USD TREND is **bullish** (99.76–102.01) — a firm-dollar backdrop that is a headwind for ex-US and a mild offset to the commodity impulse.

Commodities

Oil was the story: **Brent** ≈\$88 / **WTI** ≈\$85, +~20% in **July** on the Iran conflict before easing on the US airstrike pause. **Gold** ≈\$4,086 held the \$4,100 shelf (TREND bearish 3,991–4,139); **silver** ≈\$58 briefly popped >\$59 on Mideast headlines (TREND bearish, i.e., extended 55–60). Copper firm (**bullish**), natural gas soft (**bearish**).

5. Hedgeye Risk Ranges & Regime

Regime: US monthly Nowcast #Quad4 (July) → #Quad3 (August). Growth keeps slowing; inflation re-accelerates sequentially on the oil/commodity breakout. July was branded the **worst month for levered consensus positioning since 2023**. Source: Hedgeye Early Look “Quad Candy vs. Crowded Carnage” (29 Jul) and “Crash, Bounce, Then?” (31 Jul, 07:38 ET ≈ 19:38 GMT+8).

Immediate-term Risk Range™ Signals (from 31 Jul Early Look)

Instrument	Risk Range	TREND
US 10Y Yield (UST10Y)	4.59 – 4.71	Bullish
High Yield (HYG)	78.97 – 79.76	Neutral
Inv. Grade Corp (LQD)	105.7 – 107.3	Bearish
S&P 500 (SPX)	7,316 – 7,538	Bullish
Nasdaq Composite (COMPQ)	24,314 – 25,569	Bearish
Russell 2000 (RUT)	2,904 – 2,990	Bullish
Technology (XLK)	165 – 181	Bearish
Health Care (XLV)	159 – 168	Bullish
Real Estate (XLRE)	44.99 – 46.40	Bullish
Volatility (VIX)	15.77 – 20.56	Bearish
US Dollar Index (USD)	99.76 – 102.01	Bullish
WTI Crude (WTIC)	79.27 – 92.90	Bullish
Natural Gas (NATGAS)	2.61 – 2.93	Bearish
Gold (spot)	3,991 – 4,139	Bearish
Copper (spot)	6.19 – 6.59	Bullish
Silver (spot)	55 – 60	Bearish

Where we sit

Friday was explicitly framed as “**Day 1 of a bounce**” off immediate-term oversold in tech (XLK closed ≈166 vs its 165–181 range). The **SPX TREND is bullish** but **Nasdaq / XLK TREND is bearish** — own the index, rent the tech bounce. McCullough reduced his XLK short to **minimum size** near the lows and will stop out only on a close back above **\$180**; he added **Energy** via **XLE** and **CRAK**, and stays long healthcare, REITs, dividends and precious-adjacent. Net: respect the bounce, but the TREND signals still say growth/tech is guilty until it recaptures its levels.

6. Mag7 Scoreboard

Reactions below are to this week's prints (MSFT & META on 29 Jul; AAPL & AMZN on 30 Jul) except **Alphabet** and **Tesla**, which reported the prior week. Individual Friday closes and market caps marked "v/live" could not be pinned to a single primary source and should be verified live; **NVDA** close and the **AAPL/NVDA** caps are verified.

Name	Price	Week	Mkt Cap	P/E	Read
Nvidia (NVDA)	\$198.97	—	≈\$4.83T	~40x	No print; semis sold off. TREND bearish; June was red (~11%).
Apple (AAPL)	v/live	—	≈\$4.94T	~36x	Record \$109.4B June qtr but China/Services soft, memory crunch. Reclaimed #1 cap 27 Jul; YTD ~+22% (top Mag7).
Microsoft (MSFT)	v/live	+8–9%	v/live	~37x	Azure +43%, RPO \$678B. Only Mag7 name with a bullish TREND.
Amazon (AMZN)	v/live	+8–10%	v/live	~35x	AWS +37% (fastest since '21); first \$200.6B qtr; capex ~\$220B. TREND neutral.
Alphabet (GOOGL)	v/live	–15%	v/live	~27x	Cloud +82% but capex spooked the tape. Reported prior week.
Meta (META)	v/live	–~10%	v/live	~28x	Revenue \$60.8B (+28%) but EPS miss + heavy AI capex.
Tesla (TSLA)	≈\$306*	—	v/live	~297x	Fell post-earnings prior week; richest multiple in the group. *intra-period.

Leadership read: The Mag7 is no longer one trade. Cloud-monetizers (**MSFT**, **AMZN**) were rewarded; capex-spenders (**GOOGL**, **META**) and hardware (**NVDA**, **AAPL**) were punished. Intra-group dispersion is the widest in years — a stock-picker's tape hiding inside a cap-weighted index. Hedgeye's momentum signals agree: only MSFT bullish, AMZN neutral, the rest bearish/mixed.

7. Positioning & Options

VIX: spiked from ≈16.6 (22 Jul) to ≈20.7 (29 Jul) as the tech unwind peaked, then faded to ≈16.4 by Friday; the July range was 14.96–20.88. Hedgeye's VIX TREND is **bearish** (15.77–20.56) — vol keeps trending lower despite the pops.

Credit: high-yield spreads stayed contained (**HYG** neutral) while investment grade (**LQD**) was pressured — the damage was rate-driven, not credit-driven.

Net read: This was a **positioning/factor purge, not a systemic event** — credit calm, VIX spike round-tripped. Use vol spikes to add to Quad3 winners; the pain is concentrated in crowded growth, not the broad market.

8. Sector Rotation — Leaders & Laggards

Leaders: **Energy (XLE)** took the top weekly rank on the oil breakout; **Healthcare (XLV)** (+5.3% in July) led the daily ETF re-rank (+12); **REITs (XLRE)** +4.5%; equal-weight (**RSP** +9), plus financials, industrials and **gold (AAAU** +6). **Laggards:** **Technology/semis (XLK)** — memory –30.5%, AI data centers –19.4% — and high-beta momentum –30.9%.

Read: Leadership is rotating from long-duration growth to value/quality/commodity-linked — the textbook Quad3 playbook (energy, healthcare, REITs, dividends). KM put money where the model is, buying XLE/CRAK.

9. Corporate News — Key Earnings & Events

- **Microsoft** (29 Jul): beat; Azure +43%, RPO \$678B, 30M Copilot seats; stock +~8–9%.
- **Meta** (29 Jul): revenue \$60.8B (+28%) but EPS miss and heavy AI capex; stock –~10%.
- **Amazon** (30 Jul): first \$200.6B quarter, AWS +37% (fastest since 2021), capex ~\$220B; stock +~8–10%.

- **Apple** (30 Jul): record June-quarter revenue **\$109.4B** but Services and China soft amid a memory/chip crunch; stock fell.
- **Alphabet** (prior week): Cloud **+82%** but capex worries drove the stock **--15%**.
- **Tesla** (prior week): shares dropped post-earnings; valuation the richest in the group.
- Semis broadly weak: **Nvidia**, AMD and Intel sold off mid-week on AI-spend and geopolitics; NVDA closed **\$198.97**.
- **Apple** reclaimed the **world's most valuable company** title (27 Jul) at **≈\$4.94T**, edging Nvidia's **≈\$4.83T**.

10. Macro Data — Key Releases

US Q2 GDP (advance): 1.5% annualized, a step down from Q1.

Net: The “slowing” half of Quad3 is confirmed; growth momentum is fading even before the rate hit fully bites.

US June core PCE: 3.3% y/y (from 3.4%), headline **3.7%**; core **+0.1%** m/m. Energy fell 5.9% (gasoline -9.2%) on a temporary Mideast ceasefire.

Net: Still well above the 2% target and the energy relief looks temporary — disinflation has stalled just as oil re-accelerates.

FOMC (28–29 Jul): held **3.50–3.75%**, **9–3**, three hawkish dissents; Warsh's statement was notably shorter.

Net: No cuts on the horizon; the market now prices the first 2026 **hike** for September. The risk is a hawkish surprise.

China July manufacturing PMI: 49.2 (from 50.3) — back in contraction, ending a four-month growth run; high-tech mfg **53.3** held up.

Net: Demand is soft and stimulus pressure on Beijing builds — a disinflationary global offset, but not yet a reflation signal.

Eurozone Q2 GDP: +0.4% q/q, **+1.0%** y/y — a beat.

Net: Europe is firmer than feared; it keeps the ECB's tightening bias and a September hike live.

11. Geopolitics

The **US–Iran** confrontation escalated through July: Iranian strikes on commercial vessels drew **US CENTCOM** strikes on Iranian targets; President Trump declared the June Islamabad truce over (8 Jul), and tit-for-tat strikes followed, with US operations pushing deeper into Iran and Iranian missiles targeting regional US positions. **Strait of Hormuz** disruption drove oil **+~20%** before a late-week **US airstrike pause** cooled both crude and equity nerves.

Prediction markets (Polymarket): the Iran complex is heavily traded — ~191 Iran markets (36 on oil); the "US × Iran ceasefire by...?" market has **>\$280M** of volume, and "Strait of Hormuz traffic returns to normal by 31 July?" was among the most active. (**Specific live odds not captured — verify on Polymarket.**)

Read: Oil is hostage to headlines. A durable ceasefire is the single biggest disinflationary catalyst (bearish energy longs, bullish duration/growth); renewed escalation is the Quad3 accelerant. Keep the book barbelled to survive either tape.

12. Beyond the Markets

Summits, conferences & talks

The **FOMC (28–29 Jul)** was Warsh's second meeting as Chair; ECB commentary clustered around the Eurozone GDP/CPI prints ahead of a live September decision.

Science & frontier research

- A **quantum-sensor** advance (7 Jul) moves toward detectors for dark matter and ancient gravitational waves.
- China's **Chang'e-6** far-side samples (21 Jul) show the Moon's two hemispheres differ in how deep solar-wind particles penetrate.
- **JWST** profiled the lava-planet **55 Cancri e** (15 Jul); NASA's Swift observed a supermassive black hole tidally shredding a star ~30,000 ly away (28 Jul).

Space & frontier tech

- **SpaceX** launched a classified US reconnaissance mission from Cape Canaveral (30 Jul).
- **NASA** awarded ≈\$600M for four commercial Moon landings (2028) and selected 41 tech projects for Moon/Mars; Artemis III orbital-rehearsal prep continued.

Weather & climate (market-moving)

No single verified US weather shock this week; the energy bid was geopolitical + seasonal-demand driven. Watch the Atlantic hurricane season as a Gulf-refining and nat-gas risk into August.

Water cooler (sport, screen, games)

A busy combat-sports calendar: UFC International Fight Week wrapped and **UFC Fight Night: Ankalaev vs. Rountree Jr.** ran in Abu Dhabi (25 Jul), alongside the post-Wimbledon tennis lull.

13. Appendix — Stock Cards

Compact cards for every name materially discussed. Prices/caps marked “**verify live**” could not be tied to a single primary source this run; P/E, 52-week context and 6-month trend are directional. **Always verify live before acting.**

Nvidia (NVDA)	
Price (31 Jul)	\$198.97 (−0.9% on the day)
Mkt cap	≈\$4.83T (world #2 behind Apple)
P/E	~40x (fwd, approx)
Dividend	de minimis (~0.02% yield)
52-wk	wide range; June −11%, choppy into July
Key dates	No print this week; next earnings late Aug (verify)
6-mo trend	Round-tripped a June drawdown; largely flat into 31 Jul as semis de-rated on AI-spend and geopolitics.
Read	<i>Hedgeye TREND bearish — the AI-hardware bellwether is guilty until it recaptures its risk range.</i>

Apple (AAPL)	
Price (31 Jul)	verify live
Mkt cap	≈\$4.94T (reclaimed #1 on 27 Jul)
P/E	~36x
Dividend	~0.4% yield
52-wk	YTD ~+22%, best in the Mag7
Key dates	FQ3 (June qtr) reported 30 Jul: record \$109.4B rev
6-mo trend	Strong uptrend into a record quarter, but the print exposed China/Services softness and a memory-cost squeeze; stock pulled back.
Read	<i>Best YTD Mag7 performer, yet the growth engine is being questioned — own quality, watch the guide.</i>

Microsoft (MSFT)	
Price (31 Jul)	verify live
Mkt cap	verify live (~\$3.9T range)
P/E	~37x
Dividend	~0.7% yield
52-wk	steady leader; strengthened post-print
Key dates	FQ4 reported 29 Jul: Azure +43%, RPO \$678B
6-mo trend	Grind-higher trend reaffirmed by the cloud beat; the cleanest AI-monetization story in the group.
Read	<i>Only Mag7 name with a bullish Hedgeye TREND — the reference long for AI done right.</i>

Amazon (AMZN)	
Price (31 Jul)	verify live
Mkt cap	verify live (~\$2.5T range)
P/E	~35x
Dividend	none
52-wk	recovered hard; +~8–10% on the print

Key dates	Q2 reported 30 Jul: first \$200.6B qtr, AWS +37%
6-mo trend	Broke out on the cloud re-acceleration after a mid-year consolidation.
Read	<i>AWS growth is the bar and Amazon cleared it; capex is huge but tied to demand. TREND neutral, momentum up.</i>

Alphabet (GOOGL)	
Price (31 Jul)	verify live
Mkt cap	verify live (~\$2.6T range)
P/E	~27x (cheapest Mag7)
Dividend	~0.4% yield
52-wk	de-rated ~15% on the capex reaction
Key dates	Reported prior week: Cloud +82%
6-mo trend	Uptrend broke on the earnings reaction despite blistering Cloud growth — capex fear overwhelmed the beat.
Read	<i>Cheapest Mag7 multiple; the market is paying for spending discipline, not growth. A value-in-growth watch.</i>

Meta (META)	
Price (31 Jul)	verify live
Mkt cap	verify live
P/E	~28x
Dividend	~0.3% yield
52-wk	sharp ~10% on the print
Key dates	Q2 reported 29 Jul: rev \$60.8B (+28%), EPS miss
6-mo trend	Momentum snapped on the EPS miss and capex ramp after a strong first half.
Read	<i>Top-line still humming (+28%) but the Street wants capex-to-cash-flow proof. Re-rating risk near-term.</i>

Tesla (TSLA)	
Price (31 Jul)	≈\$306 (intra-period; verify live)
Mkt cap	verify live
P/E	~297x (far the richest Mag7)
Dividend	none
52-wk	volatile; fell after earnings prior week
Key dates	Reported prior week
6-mo trend	High-beta and range-bound to lower after the print; the most sentiment-driven name in the group.
Read	<i>The valuation leaves no margin for error — a momentum vehicle, not a value one, in a Quad3 tape that punishes both.</i>

Key ETFs referenced: XLE / CRAK (energy — Quad3 leaders), XLV (healthcare — bullish TREND), XLRE (REITs — bullish), XLK (tech — bearish), RSP (equal-weight), HYG/LQD (credit). See the Risk Range table in §5 for levels.

14. Sources & Disclaimer

Sources: CNBC, The Washington Post, 24/7 Wall St., Reuters, Yahoo Finance, Kitco, TradingKey, Benzinga, Trading Economics, Fox Business, Kiplinger, CoinDesk, CGTN, Xinhua, FXStreet, Polymarket, Spaceflight Now, ScienceDaily, and Hedgeye Risk Management (Early Look “Crash, Bounce, Then?” 31 Jul and “Quad Candy vs. Crowded Carnage” 29 Jul; MOMO Tracker; Signal Strength Stocks; ETF Pro re-rank — all 27–31 Jul 2026).

Verification note: Index closes, Fed decision, GDP/PCE/PMI prints, the Hedgeye Risk Range table and NVDA’s close are sourced to the outlets above. Several individual Mag7 Friday closes and market caps, exact yield basis-point moves, and specific Polymarket odds could not be tied to a single primary source this run and are flagged “verify live.”

Figures are for the week ending Fri 31 July 2026 close unless noted; verify live prices before acting. This document is informational and is not investment advice.